an opening for a lifeguard came up, I went to my old employer in the construction business and told him I was going to have to quit.

I worked seven days a week, ten to twelve hours a day, for $15—later $20—a week and one of the proudest statistics of my life is seventy-seven—the number of people I saved during those seven summers.

Besides swimming and football, I found two other loves while I was at Dixon High. The first was named Margaret, the other was named acting.

About the same time I was entering high school, the elders of our church hired a new minister. On the Sunday that he preached his first sermon, I looked around and spotted three attractive new members of the congregation; they were his daughters.

Perhaps it was love at first sight, I'm not sure. But I was immediately drawn to one of them. Her name was Margaret Cleaver and, like my mother, she was short, pretty, auburn haired, and intelligent. For almost six years of my life I was sure she was going to be my wife. I was very much in love.

One day when I was out with Margaret she brought up Jack's drinking; it was during one of the times when he'd gone off the wagon, and somebody had given her a vivid account of his behavior.

Coming from a very religious, strict family, she was quite upset. Of course, I'd never said anything to her about Jack's problem with alcohol and had tried to keep it a secret.

I tried to tell her what Nelle had told us about Jack's problem, that it was a *sickness*, but she'd never heard anything like that before and didn't buy it.

My heart was just about broken. I thought I was going to lose her.

When I went home, I told my mother about it and said that if I did lose Margaret because of Jack, I didn't know what I'd do, but I'd probably disown him and never speak to him